

NATASHA M. DAAS

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Northeastern University, GPA: 3.85
B.S. in Computer Science and Media Arts || Animation Concentration

Boston, MA
Sep 2021 - Apr 2026

SKILLS

Technical	Java, C++, Python, Javascript, PyQt, OpenGL, C#, SDL, GLSL, React.js, Node.js, MySQL, VEX, MEL, Rez, Algorithms and Data Structures, Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), Computer Graphics, Database Design, MongoDB, Three.js, Web Development, UI/UX, Agile Development, CI/CD, MacOS, Windows, Linux, GitHub, GitLab Runners, Postman, REST APIs (HTTP), SDLC, Jest
DCC Proficiencies	Maya, Houdini, Blender, Unity, USD, Adobe Substance Painter, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe After Effects, Nuke, Modeling, Texturing, XGen, Marvelous Designer, Arnold, 3D Animation, Compositing
Misc.	Deadline Monitor, Shotgun API, ShotGrid, Jira/Kanban, Linear Algebra, 3D Math, Qt Designer

EXPERIENCE

Walt Disney Imagineering **Jun 2026 - Present**
Pipeline Technical Director Intern (official title: Visual Effects Design Intern) **Glendale, CA**

- Developing pipeline tools and shelf scripts for compositing, 2D FX, previs/layout, and motion graphics, delivering bug fixes and automation for project initialization, ShotGrid asset management, and rendering workflows.
- Serving as the primary technical point of contact for Houdini, developing Python shelf tools and HDAs to automate artist workflows, enforce production naming conventions, and improve pipeline efficiency.
- Diagnosing time-sensitive render and pipeline failures by debugging Houdini scenes, Deadline plugins, and render jobs to resolve missing assets, ROP errors, and submission issues.
- Supporting automated vendor delivery workflows by troubleshooting Aspera ingest failures, ShotGrid synchronization issues, and publish/template matching errors.
- Maintaining pipeline configuration files and production templates to support evolving show requirements, manage project ingests, and ensure reliable asset publishing workflows.

Walt Disney Imagineering **Jan - Jul 2025**
Pipeline Technical Director Intern (official title: Visual Effects Design Intern) **Glendale, CA**

- Resolved Jira tickets across Maya, Nuke, Houdini, After Effects, and Deadline Monitor (using Rez and Git) and provided daily front-line support to artists and video media designers as the technical point of contact for AE.
- Developed a Python-ExtendScript bridge for After Effects, standardizing workflows across DCCs (Maya, Nuke, AE), to enable project dependency tracking and version management in AE.
- Integrated a major DCC software upgrade into the studio pipeline by modifying Deadline scripts and debugging test farm jobs, Linux/Windows render nodes, and third-party plugin compatibility errors.
- Optimized Nuke post-encode processes with custom Deadline plugins, automating cleanup jobs.

Nickelodeon Animation Studios **Jun - Aug 2024**
Data Strategy Intern **Burbank, CA**

- Developed an ETL pipeline using Python to automate the standardization and cleaning of data from multiple sources, aiding in the consolidation of a single source of truth for all studio data.
- Built reporting tools in Tableau that visualize centralized studio data and provide actionable insights for stakeholders in cross-functional teams, including HR, Production Operations, and Artist Management.
- Spearheaded frontend and backend development in a cross-functional team of 17 on the NICKtern project to build a [Nickelodeon+](#) website prototype using TypeScript, React, Node.js, and JSON.

Northeastern University **Jul - Dec 2023**
System Support Associate **Boston, MA**

- Enhanced user experience by migrating 15 Northeastern web pages to the Slate platform using Javascript and CSS.
- Provided IT support to 50+ employees, resolving technical issues, managing software and hardware installations, implementing software updates and troubleshooting network problems to ensure seamless daily operations.

PROJECTS

[Maya USD Variant Author Toolkit](#) Python | USD | Qt | PySide

Shelf tools to author and manage variant sets within Maya • Implemented support for geometry, transform, and material variants to facilitate flexible lookdev and asset configuration workflows

[AI Standard Surface Pipeline Tool \(Substance Painter → Maya\)](#) Maya | Adobe Substance Painter | Python | MEL | Qt
Pipeline tool for importing AI Standard Surface textures from Substance Painter into Maya • Automated texture import, shader node creation, and UV-based material assignment

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEERING

Asians in Animation (AIA) Email & Newsletter Assistant

Sep 2024 - Present